Ashcombe & Vale Chartered Accountants

Suite 4, Marlowe Chambers, 12 Fore Street, Ashcombe, AC4 8JE | www.ashcombevale-example.co.uk

Secretary / Administrative Assistant

Reference: REF: AV-ADM-2026-009

Location:	Ashcombe town centre office (on-site, free parking)
Department:	Practice Administration
Reports to:	Practice Manager
Contract:	Permanent, Full-time (37.5 hrs/week, Mon–Fri 09:00–17:30)
Salary:	£24,000 – £27,500 per annum, depending on experience
Start date:	October 2026

About Us

Ashcombe & Vale is a well-established firm of chartered accountants serving around 400 small business, farming and private clients across the region. Our team of 14 prides itself on a friendly, personal service — many of our clients have been with the firm for decades. The front office is the heart of the practice: the first voice clients hear and the person who keeps the partners' diaries, post and paperwork moving.

The Role

We are looking for an organised and personable Secretary / Administrative Assistant to run our front office. You will be the first point of contact for clients, manage correspondence and filing, prepare engagement letters and meeting packs, and provide day-to-day secretarial support to three partners. This is a varied role suited to someone who takes pride in accuracy, discretion and a tidy desk.

Key Responsibilities

- Answer telephones, greet clients and manage the reception area to a professional standard
- Manage partners' diaries: scheduling client meetings, HMRC deadline reminders and room bookings
- Type and format letters, engagement letters, meeting minutes and reports from dictation and drafts
- Handle incoming and outgoing post, DX and courier items; maintain the client records and filing system
- Prepare and send client onboarding packs; collect ID documents for anti-money-laundering checks
- Take card and bank transfer payments and issue receipts; assist with fee-note queries
- Order office supplies and liaise with IT support, cleaners and building management
- Provide overflow administrative support to the bookkeeping and payroll teams at busy periods

Essential Requirements

- Previous secretarial, receptionist or office administration experience (1+ year preferred, but attitude counts most)
- Confident telephone manner and a warm, professional way with clients face-to-face
- Good working knowledge of Microsoft Word, Excel and Outlook
- Accurate typing (approx. 50+ wpm) with strong spelling and grammar
- Excellent organisation and the ability to juggle several tasks without dropping details

- Discretion — you will routinely handle confidential financial and personal information

Desirable (Not Essential)

- Experience in an accountancy, legal or other professional-services office
- Familiarity with practice management software (e.g. Iris, CCH, Xero Practice Manager)
- Audio typing experience
- GCSEs (or equivalent) including English and Maths at grade C/4 or above

What We Offer

- 22 days annual leave plus bank holidays, increasing with service
- Employer pension contribution of 5%
- Christmas office closure (approx. 3 extra days) and early finish on summer Fridays
- Study support available if you wish to work towards AAT or an administration qualification
- Free on-site parking and a genuinely friendly, stable team

How to Apply

Please email your CV and a short covering letter to office@ashcombevale-example.co.uk, quoting reference AV-ADM-2026-009. Shortlisted candidates will be invited to a first interview with the Practice Manager, including a short typing and Word formatting exercise, followed by a meeting with the partners.

Closing date: Friday 4 September 2026, 17:00

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE DOCUMENT — created for CV-screening software testing only. This organisation, vacancy and contact details are fictional.